



WORLD VOVINAM FEDERATION (WVVF)

171 Tung Thien Vuong street – Phu Dinh Ward – Ho Chi Minh City – Vietnam

Tel: 0084 8 38933007 – 0084 8 38685095

Email: WVVF@vovinam.net.vn



WVVF

Short Rulebook for

Competitions



SHORT VERSION OF RULES FOR TECHNICAL COMPETITIONS

I. General

- In case, the following rules refer to an athlete, it can be implied that both male and female athletes, as well as pairs or teams (e.g. for Song Luyện or Đa Luyện competitions) are meant.

II. Procedure

- The athlete for the technical competitions will be called by the Organizing Committee (OC) up to three times, with at least 1 minute in between.
- If the athlete fails to show up on time after the third time, they are automatically disqualified.
- After performing the technical competition, the athlete waits at the side of the tatami until his total score has been announced, before leaving the competition area.
- After that, the next athlete will be called for the first time.

III. Determining the winner of a technical competition

- For technical competitions, five referees will award a score of up to 100 points each.
- The total score of an athlete and the winner of a category are determined as follows:
 - The highest and lowest scores are eliminated and the sum of the remaining scores is calculated. This is the total score of the athlete.
 - The gold medal is awarded to the highest total score, silver medal to second highest total score, and two bronze medals to third and fourth highest total score.
- If there are two or more athletes with equal points and they may be eligible for the medal rankings, additional rules are considered in the following order to determine the ranking in the category.
 - If the athletes have the third highest score, both will receive the bronze medal and the athlete with the fourth highest score will not receive a medal.
 - If the athletes are tied for the first, second or fourth highest total score, the ranking will be determined as follows:
 - The scores which were previously eliminated (highest and lowest) will be considered for the total sum. The athlete with the higher total sum will be ranked higher.
 - If the score is still equal, only the highest score is compared. The athlete with the higher maximum score is the winner.
 - Ultimately, the score is deleted, and the athletes re-do their performance for this rank. This does not affect their score from the first performance. The athletes allowed a rest time of at least 10 minutes, and the starting order will be re-drawn. The referees can be changed for this process.
 - This process is repeated until one athlete has the higher score.
- Examples are shown in the Annex.

IV. Challenges and complaints

- Only the head coach is authorized to file a complaint, which must be submitted as an official letter along with a fee of USD 200 in cash.
- Technical complaints must be submitted to the Organizing Committee within 10 minutes after the technical category has ended.



WORLD VOVINAM FEDERATION (WVVF)

171 Tung Thien Vuong street – Phu Dinh Ward – Ho Chi Minh City – Vietnam

Tel: 0084 8 38933007 – 0084 8 38685095

Email: WVVF@vovinam.net.vn

-
- All complaints will be reviewed and resolved before the next competition begins. The USD 200 fee will only be refunded if the issue is resolved exactly as stated in the official complaint letter.



WORLD VOVINAM FEDERATION (WVVF)

171 Tung Thien Vuong street – Phu Dinh Ward – Ho Chi Minh City – Vietnam

Tel: 0084 8 38933007 – 0084 8 38685095

Email: WVVF@vovinam.net.vn

SHORT VERSION OF RULES FOR FIGHTING COMPETITIONS

I. Time

- Each match has 3 rounds, 2 minutes per round with a 1-minute rest between rounds.
- In case of draw: Golden scoring extra round with a maximum duration of 2 minutes (see Section XIV).

II. Equipment

- Uniform Võ Phục: Blue Vovinam uniform Võ Phục with country name.
- Belt: Yellow belt without any stripes/degrees.
- Safety helmet: red/blue color – will be provided by the Organizing Committee.
- Own gum-shield (teeth protector).
- Armor: Body protector red/blue color – will be provided by the Organizing Committee.
- Boxing gloves: 10 oz, red/blue color – will be provided by the Organizing Committee.
- Own groin-guard – below the Võ Phục's trousers.
- Own shins and legs protections – to be worn below the Võ Phục's trousers.
- Feet protections are optional.
- Forearms protections - below the Võ Phục's sleeves.
- New rule: Each athlete may have up to two coaches at his side. The coaches must wear the team uniform.

III. Referee

- Five corner referees (CoRe): Evaluating impacts of point 1 and point 2 (see Section VI).
- One Center referee: (CeRe) Giving penalties for forbidden actions, pointing the exit of competition area and fall downs, validating Đòn Chân Tấn Công (DCTC) techniques. showing Phản Đòn techniques, etc. (see Section VI and VII).
- One point referee (PoRe): Recording the penalties given by Center referee.
- Senior referee: oversees the competition, makes decisions on challenges and has the right to stop the fight, etc.

IV. Areas of point

- Head area (from the hairline on the forehead/temples down through the face to the chin).
- Abdominal area (front of abdomen to waistband, chest, sides and back).

V. Areas without point

- Blows from the shoulders outward to the arms, from the waist down and the neck and nape area.
- Impacts with hands and feet with a low impact or which are being stopped by defensive actions.

VI. Point 1 and Point 2

- Fight consists of offensive and defensive permitted actions of up to 5 consecutive actions. After that either the athletes must take a step back before resuming the attacking cascade or the CeRe has to shortly pause the fight.



WORLD VOVINAM FEDERATION (WVVF)

171 Tung Thien Vuong street – Phu Dinh Ward – Ho Chi Minh City – Vietnam

Tel: 0084 8 38933007 – 0084 8 38685095

Email: WVVF@vovinam.net.vn

- Plus 1 point:
 - Effective kick(s) or punch(es) to the body.
 - Effective punch(es) to the head.
 - Causing the opponent to fall down, by touching the ground with any part of the body except the feet (the point is given by CeRe).
 - Causing the opponent to fall down after successfully applying a DCTC #3 or #6 (CeRe).
- Plus 2 points:
 - Effective kick to the head.
 - Effective serial attack consisting of kick(s) AND punch(es).
 - Effective Chém Quét and other eligible (!) Vovinam Phán Đòn techniques that lead to the fall of the opponent with the athlete still standing (CeRe).
 - Effective Đòn Chân Tấn Công #3, #6, #7, #8, #9, #10 (CeRe).
 - Opponent is Knocked Down for the count (CeRe).
 - If athlete has at least one case of a “COUNTED” Đòn Chân Tấn Công (given at the end of the round by CeRe).
This case is only applicable in the first two rounds and can be applied only once.

VII. Minus Points

- Minus points can only be awarded by the CeRe.
- Minus 1 point:
 - Rule change: As soon as one foot touches the outside of the fighting area, it is counted as a mat escape.
- Minus 2 points:
 - For receiving Warning (Cảnh Cáo) or 3 Reminders (Nhắc Nhở).
 - If athlete performs DCTC during Round 3 or the golden round (see Section IX).

VIII. No point

In case no points shall be rewarded, this is shown by the CeRe. Examples are listed below:

- Athlete falls or exits behind the competition area during an attempt to perform a DCTC.
- Athlete exits the competition area as a result of intentional pushing by the opponent.
- Both athletes exit the competition area together while attacking.
- Both athletes fall together while attacking.
- Punches or any strikes while being in a clinch.
- When the athlete falls outside of the competition arena, no additional minus point is given.



WORLD VOVINAM FEDERATION (WVVF)

171 Tung Thien Vuong street – Phu Dinh Ward – Ho Chi Minh City – Vietnam

Tel: 0084 8 38933007 – 0084 8 38685095

Email: WVVF@vovinam.net.vn

IX. Đòn Chân Tấn Công (DCTC)

Đòn Chân Tấn Công (DCTC) are one of the “specialties” from Vovinam. As such, their successful application in a fight, as well as the attempt shall be rewarded greatly. Due to their complexity in the nature of the various Đòn Chân, some are forbidden (namely the numbers 1, 2, 4, 5, and 11-21) and for the others there are four levels of evaluation:

- **“NOT COUNTED”** if DCTC is not effective and/or not executed correctly.
- **“COUNTED”** if DCTC is executed correctly but not strong enough or not executed correctly (see below).
- **“COUNTED + 1 POINTS”** for attacking the opponent with DCTC #3 or #6.
The attack must be performed frontally, AND with both legs tightly closed above the knee line. The attacked opponent is thrown off balance but does not fall but puts one or both hands on the floor for support.
- **“COUNTED + 2 POINTS”** for attacking the opponent with DCTC #3, #6, #7, #8, #9, #10 (resulting in the opponent losing his balance or fall to the ground):
 - **Đòn Chân Tấn Công #3 or #6:**
Attack is performed frontally AND with both legs tightly closed above the knee line AND the attacker must twist the lock AND with the result that the opponent falls backwards to the ground.
 - **Đòn Chân Tấn Công #7, #8, #9 or #10:**
Attack is performed frontally. During the point of contact the attacker’s head must be above the opponent’s belt AND both legs must touch the opponent while at least one leg must touch a valid area of point (see section VI. above the line of the opponent’s belt) AND which results in the opponent losing his balance or falling to the ground.

X. Forbidden

- Attack on the throat, neck, groin, at the joints.
- Using elbow, knee, Đá Búa (Axe Kick) to attack the opponent.
- Attacking the opponent while he is knocked down.
- Intentional use of wrestling (Vật) techniques for attack or defense.
- Clinching.
- Kicks below the belt line.
- Using Đòn Chân Tấn Công #1, #2, #4, #5, #11 – 21.
- Catching the opponent’s leg from outside in and attacking (wrong Vovinam technique).
- Misconduct: rude and vulgar behavior, non-ethical expression or gesture.
- Ignoring the commands of the referee (attack before or after) or not submitting to the decisions of the referee.
- Passivity or deliberate avoiding the fight, simulation of injury.
- The use of prohibited drugs or substances.

XI. Level of penalties

- Reminders (Nhắc Nhở) are the first level of penalty, e.g. given for the breaking the rules listed in section X.
- Warnings (Cảnh Cáo) are given when accumulating three Reminders (Nhắc Nhở) or a gross violation of the rules listed in section X.



WORLD VOVINAM FEDERATION (WVVF)

171 Tung Thien Vuong street – Phu Dinh Ward – Ho Chi Minh City – Vietnam

Tel: 0084 8 38933007 – 0084 8 38685095

Email: WVVF@vovinam.net.vn

- Disqualification: an athlete loses the match by disqualification if he accumulates 3 Warnings (Cảnh Cáo).
- If an athlete consistently shows vulgar and rude behavior, or specifically use the forbidden techniques to attack, which leads to a serious injury to the opponent, the referee has the right to disqualify that athlete without being previously subjected to three levels of penalties.
- Please note: Coaches also need to adhere to a high level of respect and standard. Otherwise, they can be removed from the competition area for this match.

XII. Winner

- The winner of the match is the athlete who scored the more points after the completion of all rounds.

XIII. Winning before the full duration of the match

- The opponent is knocked out. This includes.
 - The opponent is unable to continue the fight, after a decision by the CeRe or being counted to ten.
 - The opponent gets knocked down 3 times in one round or 4 times in a match.
 - The opponent visits the doctor mid-match 5 times during a round or 7 times in total per match.
 - When the doctor does not allow the opponent to continue the fight.
- The athlete accumulates a 10-points difference over the opponent.
- The opponent or his coach refuses the continuation of the match (refusal).
- The opponent is disqualified.
- The opponent is not present after being called three times by the organizing committee (absent).
- Observing the technical superiority of one competitor (senior referee decision).
- New rule: The opponent does not have a coach at his side.

XIV. Golden round (draw)

- If after three official rounds both competitors have the same number of points, a “golden scoring extra round” (abbreviated golden round) will be held with a duration of two minutes. If any competitor scores first, the match will end at that moment and the competitor with the higher score will be declared the winner.
- During the golden it is forbidden to perform DCTC techniques. If an athlete tries to anyways, the athlete will be penalized with minus 2 points and loses the match immediately.
- The Reminders (Nhắc Nhở) and Warnings (Cảnh Cáo) from the previous three rounds are carried over to this golden round.
- If the golden round ends with a draw, there will be a break of 1 minute. After the break, another golden round will begin with a duration of 2 minutes. The rules stated above are then applied. This rule is repeated until a winner is determined.

XV. Note

- Time to hold Phản Đòn techniques - no more than 2 seconds.
- Competitions are held according to the Olympic system with elimination after the first defeat, without determining 3rd place. Athletes who lose in the semi-finals will both receive a bronze medal.
- The drawing takes place before the first day of the championships. The fighter on the top part



WORLD VOVINAM FEDERATION (WVVF)

171 Tung Thien Vuong street – Phu Dinh Ward – Ho Chi Minh City – Vietnam

Tel: 0084 8 38933007 – 0084 8 38685095

Email: WVVF@vovinam.net.vn

of the tree wears will be wearing red, while the other will be wearing blue (see Annex).

- The losers of the semifinals will both automatically receive the 3rd place.

XVI. Arbitration of the injury situations that prevent the continuation of the match

- The presence of an injury, its severity, and the possibility to continue the fight is determined by the competition's doctor.
- If a permitted technique is used and the opponent cannot continue the fight, the opponent loses the match. The athlete shall be awarded a clear win.
- If an opponent cannot continue the fight after receiving a forbidden attack, the athlete causing the knock down will lose the match. The opponent shall be awarded a win, but cannot continue in the next round, if there is any.
- In the unlikely case both athletes cannot continue the fight at the same time, both lose their match. If this happens in the final, two silver medals are awarded.
- Exemptions from these rules can be decided by the CeRe together with the CoRe and the Head of referee or his deputy on the advice of a competition doctor. This rule prevents an athlete pretending to be unable to continue the fight after an illegal attack, to win the match.

XVII. Challenges and complaints

Purpose of Challenges:

- The head coach or coach(es) of an athlete competing in the Fighting Competition can challenge either a decision made by the Center Referee (CeRe) or actions where the CeRe did not make any decisions or hand gestures (referred to as “non- decisions”).
- Decisions regarding points awarded by the Corner Referees (CoRe) cannot be challenged, as a majority vote from the CoRes is already required to award points.

Who can challenge and how often:

- Each team will receive one challenge card per match, in the color of their Athlete (red or blue).
- Each team is allowed up to one challenge per round, provided they still have their challenge card.
- Challenges can only be initiated by the coach. If the Athlete wishes to challenge, they must communicate through their coach.

Procedure of a challenge:

- To challenge a decision or non-decision by the CeRe, the coach raises their card and clearly states “Challenge!”
- The CeRe will pause the match (“Ngung”) and approach the coach for clarification on the challenge. The coach must specify the exact action being challenged.
- The CeRe gives the challenge card to the Table Referee and explains the content of the challenge.
- The challenge is communicated via microphone to the CoRes and the audience.
- The Referees gather to discuss the challenge and work towards reaching a unanimous decision. For this, the head referee may be consulted.
- The head referee (or their deputy), along with the CeRe, CoRes and the PoRe, may review the video material to assist in reaching a decision.
 - **If the challenge is upheld:**
The decision or non-decision will be corrected, and the challenge card will be returned to the coach. The match will then resume.



WORLD VOVINAM FEDERATION (WVVF)

171 Tung Thien Vuong street – Phu Dinh Ward – Ho Chi Minh City – Vietnam

Tel: 0084 8 38933007 – 0084 8 38685095

Email: WVVF@vovinam.net.vn

○ **If the challenge is denied:**

The challenge card will not be returned, and the match will resume.

- All decisions made after a challenge has been reviewed are final and not subject to further appeal.
- The result of the challenge will be clearly communicated to the fighters and the audience by the main table speaker.
- Challenges may only review actions that took place within the 15 seconds immediately prior to the request.

Complaints:

- Only the head coach is authorized to file a complaint, which must be submitted as an official letter along with a fee of USD 200 in cash.
- Complaints regarding personnel (competitor or referee) must be submitted to the Organizing Committee prior to the draw.
- Technical complaints must be submitted within 10 minutes after the match to the Organizing Committee.
- All complaints will be reviewed and resolved before the next competition begins. The USD200 fee will only be refunded if the issue is resolved exactly as stated in the official complaint letter.

ON BEHALF OF WVVF E.C. – Sports Commission

Mr. Vittorio Cera
Chairman of Sports Commission

Mr. Giuseppe Pollastro
Director of Competition Committee

Dr. Dinh Du Tran
Director of Referee Committee



WORLD VOVINAM FEDERATION (WVVF)

171 Tung Thien Vuong street – Phu Dinh Ward – Ho Chi Minh City – Vietnam

Tel: 0084 8 38933007 – 0084 8 38685095

Email: WVVF@vovinam.net.vn

Annex

Examples for technical scores and how to award medals

For a technical competition the following five athletes get the following points. The red scores are the highest and lowest scores, which will be eliminated in the first step. For additional cases to be considered, the relevant scores are highlighted with underlines.

	Score	Score	Score	Score	Score	Total Score	Rank	Total Score	Rank	Rank
Athlete	1	2	3	4	5	Without Max/Min	Without Max/Min	With Max/Min	With Max/Min	Only Max
A	<u>94</u>	91	90	89	<u>88</u>	270	1	452	1	
B	<u>93</u>	91	90	89	<u>88</u>	270	1	451	2	
C	92	90	90	89	88	269	3	449	3	
D	92	89	90	89	88	268	4	448	4	
E	92	88	90	89	88	267	5	447	5	

After eliminating the highest and lowest score, A and B have the same total score.

However, after reconsidering the previously eliminated scores, A has the higher total score and is awarded the gold medal.

	Score	Score	Score	Score	Score	Total Score	Rank	Total Score	Rank	Rank
Athlete	1	2	3	4	5	Without Max/Min	Without Max/Min	With Max/Min	With Max/Min	Only Max
A	<u>94</u>	91	90	89	<u>87</u>	270	1	451	1	1
B	<u>93</u>	91	90	89	<u>88</u>	270	1	451	1	2
C	92	90	90	89	88	269	3	449	3	3
D	92	89	90	89	88	268	4	448	4	4
E	92	88	90	89	88	267	5	447	5	5

Here, after considering the previously eliminated scores, A and B are still equal. But after considering only the highest score, A has the higher score and is awarded the gold medal.

	Score	Score	Score	Score	Score	Total Score	Rank	Total Score	Rank	Rank
Athlete	1	2	3	4	5	Without Max/Min	Without Max/Min	With Max/Min	With Max/Min	Only Max
A	93	91	90	89	88	270	1	451	1	???
B	93	91	90	89	88	270	1	451	1	???
C	92	90	90	89	88	269	3	449	3	3
D	92	89	90	89	88	268	4	448	4	4
E	92	88	90	89	88	267	5	447	5	5

After considering all cases, A and B have the same score. Therefore, A and B redo the competition, after which the athlete with the higher score will be awarded the gold and the other the silver medal. Athlete C and D both get the bronze medal.



WORLD VOVINAM FEDERATION (WVVF)

171 Tung Thien Vuong street – Phu Dinh Ward – Ho Chi Minh City – Vietnam

Tel: 0084 8 38933007 – 0084 8 38685095

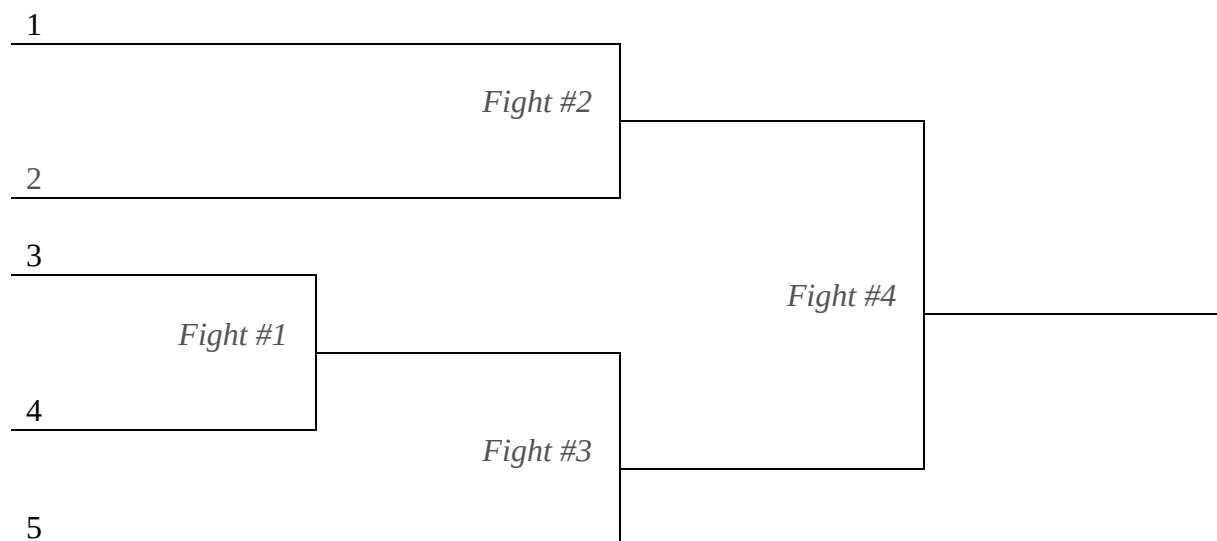
Email: WVVF@vovinam.net.vn

	Score	Score	Score	Score	Score	Total Score	Rank	Total Score	Rank	Rank
Athlete	1	2	3	4	5	Without Max/Min	Without Max/Min	With Max/Min	With Max/Min	Only Max
A	92	92	90	89	88	271	1	451	1	1
B	92	91	90	89	88	270	2	450	2	2
C	92	90	90	89	88	269	3	449	3	3
D	92	89	90	89	88	268	4	448	4	???
E	92	89	90	89	88	268	4	448	4	???

Two bronze medals can be awarded. In the above case Athletes D and E have the identical score after considering all cases. Therefore, both have to do redo the competition, after which only the athlete with the higher score will be awarded the bronze medal.

Exemplary competition bracket

Example for 5 competitors:



Fight #1: Athlete 3 in red versus athlete 4 in blue.

Fight #2: Athlete 1 in red versus athlete 2 in blue.

Fight #3: Winner of fight #1 in red versus Athlete 5 in blue.

Fight #4: Winner of fight #2 in red versus winner of fight #3 in blue.